

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 494

By McKenzie

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Mary Elizabeth Goins.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Mary Elizabeth Goins; and

WHEREAS, Mary Goins was an exemplary and conscientious public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, born in New Market to George Franklin Staffney, Sr., and Lillian Henderson Staffney, Mrs. Goins was one of four children; she had three siblings: George Staffney, Julia Roper, and Dorothy Staffney; and

WHEREAS, Mary Goins attended Cottage Hill Elementary School and then graduated from Nelson Merry High School, where she played guard on the school's basketball team and sang in the choir; and

WHEREAS, her participation in high school sports was a manifestation of an inner passion, and throughout her life, she followed baseball, basketball, and football, amassing a profound depth of knowledge in each sport; and

WHEREAS, she cultivated a tender affection for the art of gardening, a love that her father first instilled in her through their family garden in New Market, and while she was still able, she maintained a vegetable garden and flowerbed that witnessed countless captivating blooms over the years; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from high school in 1940, she moved to Knoxville, where she found work at Miller's Department Store, and forty years later, she retired from Sears,

Roebuck, and Company, having been always beloved by her coworkers for her attention to detail and solicitude for her customers; and

WHEREAS, with an indomitable industriousness, Mrs. Goins also served as an Avon representative during her work career and in her retirement; and

WHEREAS, she was married to her beloved husband, Thomas Lace Goins, for sixty-four years, a union blessed with three children, and she enjoyed a wealth of grandchildren and great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, a woman of deep and abiding faith, Mrs. Goins was an eighty-year member of Clinton Chapel AME Zion Church, where she was the oldest member of the congregation; in addition to the daily bread of her religious television programming, she furthered her already intimate relationship with the Lord through generous service to Clinton Chapel, including serving as Director of Christian Education, a Sunday School teacher, and president of the Helen Spurgeon Circle Missionary Society; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Goins enjoyed playing bridge with the Saturday Night Cotillion Bridge Club, and she was also a consistent community servant, whether through helping with early voting or raising funds for service projects such as the Heart Fund; her other interests included watching her favorite game shows and listening to religious music and audio books; and

WHEREAS, a blessing to all who had the good fortune of knowing her, Mrs. Goins attributed her longevity to reading and studying the Bible, attending Sunday School and church, and following the principles outlined in Matthew 7:12 and James 1:5-6; and

WHEREAS, Mary Goins leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Mary Elizabeth Goins, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character as a public servant and human being and commending her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.